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BITTER MEMORIES Visitors at the Partition Museum; (below) 'Zuljanah', an installation by Kashmiri artist Veer Munshi, shows a horse carrying skeletons

ART

LEST WE FORGET

Apart from invaluable eyewitness accounts, New Delhi's **Partition Museum** also links the historic calamity with the city's evolution

WHEN WE TALK ABOUT AN EVENT AS MOMENTOUS and tragic as the Partition of India (and the violence on both sides of the border), the stories therein aren't restricted to words or even images. There are also physical objects inextricably linked to the event. A skilled curator, therefore, is tasked with sculpting a narrative around these objects—or rather, setting the stage for visitors to carve their own narratives out of this profusion of raw material. New Delhi's recently opened Partition Museum, at Ambedkar University's Dara Shikoh Library Building, succeeds in doing this, for the most part. This is the second such museum dedicated to the Partition of India—the first, set up by The Arts and Cultural Heritage Trust (TACHT) in 2016, is in Amritsar. Kishwar Desai, the chairperson of TACHT, conceptualised both the Delhi and the Amritsar museums.

Delhi's Partition Museum has been divided into six galleries—Towards Independence and Partition, Migration, Refuge, Rebuilding Home, Rebuilding Relationships and, finally, Hope and Courage.

The Partition Museum has two primary strengths—one is the sheer diversity of eyewitness accounts on display. Each account has its own TV screen with headphones attached. A lot of the eyewitnesses have large, tastefully executed black-and-



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LASTING TRADITIONS Installations at Shilpa Deergha; (right) the Yatra section of the gallery

Photographs courtesy: DASTKAR HAAT SAMITI

Art by the People

ART

The **Shilp Deergha** gallery at the new Parliament building celebrates the crafts traditions of India



One of the major attractions at India's newly-constructed Parliament complex is the Shilp Deergha, part of the ground floor galleries and designed to exhibit the various arts and crafts forms from across India—whether it is embroidery, textile work, metal sculptures, block printing or terracotta. The Shilp Deergha, conceptualised by Jaya Jaitly (founder and president of the Dastkari Haat Samiti) has been divided into eight parts, which correspond to eight